

11 June 2003

Dear Jen,

It's almost noon and I will go on shift in two hours. Right now I am sitting in my room listening to Eminem's first album. I borrowed the CD from SSG Franklin and copied it onto my computer. I have burned a lot of music, but I don't the much of an opportunity to listen to it—"My Name is.....Slim Shady, my English teacher wanted to flunk me in Junior High. Thanks a lot, next semester I'll be 35..."

These days I am having a motivation problem. I find it very difficult to make myself to very much at work. I don't know what the major problem is, but I wish that I could get over it. I just don't do very well in a reactive environment. If I don't have a clear objective, I tend to struggle. I don't like jobs that are repetitive and on-going. I need to have something to work towards and something to show for my effort. Last night, Lt. Simonson asked me if we had updated the combat power during our shift. We had not since there was a lot going on. When I told he told me that "I was slacking." I told him to fuck off. I have been in this same position since the beginning of the war, and he has only been here for less than two weeks. Meanwhile, while I was here, he went back to Ft. Riley on emergency leave so really—Fuck Off.

The Chaplain, Captain Palmer, lives in the "Lt. Lair" with me, Kimball, and Simonson. I get to talk to him a lot and he is frustrated as well. He feels that he does not get very much support from our commanders and is having problems doing what he is here for. Now isn't that ironic; I seem to have the same problem. He is concerned by the fact that we have not had a break in three months, and a lot of the soldiers he talks to are very stressed. Additionally, he is not thrilled by our new lingo. The soldiers have started referring to all Iraqis as "terrorists." I think its funny and I don't care, but CPT Palmer is concerned that if we don't get some relief someone will do something stupid. I don't think it's that serious, but it is clear that almost everyone here is wearing out.

Everyone except for Sproesser, that is. He stopped by yesterday. He was back from Ace for the day so that he could go to the PX. He seems genuinely happy now that he is away from the daily grind in the TOC. He really enjoys CA work, and I have to admit that it makes me jealous. Oh well, I can't blame him. I would be equally excited to be out there working on real world projects.

Since we do not know how long we are going to be over here, I have thought about how you would handle having a second baby without me there. I decided that doesn't necessarily have to happen. Just make sure that when you get ready to have the baby you go see the doctor and explain to him that you won't be able to have the baby and take care of Mason at the same time. If you can impress this upon him, maybe you will be able to send me a Red Cross message—and I will be able to come back for as much as two weeks to help out. It just makes more sense. Whatever you do, do not go through the FRG because they will try to find a way to handle it all in the rear.